

Meanwhile, he was putting in over forty hours per week on *ChooseFI* as it started to take off. Throw in a newborn son and life really got interesting.

Jonathan was constantly thinking about the next three or four things. Everything was urgent. He said, “I was just doing dumb stuff, like I would go fill up the car with gas and then I would leave the seal on the gas tank off because I had already moved onto the next mental object in my mind. And that’s just a dangerous and stressful place to find yourself.” He soon realized that something had to give.

Fall 2017 was an especially busy time for Jonathan, and he needed to take significant time off to explore opportunities that presented themselves related to *ChooseFI*. He had already planned a trip to visit his wife’s family in Cape Town, South Africa. He decided to ask his boss for an unpaid leave of absence to give himself a few weeks to hit pause on the professional part of life. While he thought it was a reasonable request, his employer disagreed. His boss forced his hand by denying the request, informing Jonathan that he would have to step down to a lesser role if he wanted to take the time.

So he quit his job.

Jonathan said, “I don’t think that was the answer he was expecting. I don’t think you see that very often. But that is what